

Self Reflection- Maia

Before this project, I mostly understood generative AI as a tool that could create images, text, music, and other forms of media based on prompts. After experimenting with it more directly, I realized that the process is not as straightforward as simply describing what you want and receiving an exact result. There is a lot of experimentation involved, which can make it interesting in creative fields.

For this project, I worked with Stable Diffusion through the Diffusers library to create a series of surreal collages. I kept the main idea and visual style consistent while changing only the setting between each prompt. What surprised me was how much the images changed even when only a few words were different. I expected the results to look much more like variations of each other, but keeping that consistency was actually one of the more difficult parts of the process. I also experimented with negative prompts and found that they could guide the image, but did not always remove the elements I wanted them to.

A generative AI project that I find interesting is Refik Anadol's *Unsupervised*. The work uses machine learning and data from artworks in the Museum of Modern Art's collection to create constantly changing abstract visuals. What I like about it is that the AI is not being used just to recreate an existing image. Instead, it becomes part of the process of interpreting a collection of art and turning it into something new.

Overall, this project made me see generative AI as something that requires experimentation. There is still a lot of control from the person using it, but there is also an unpredictable element. I think that balance can be useful creatively because sometimes the unexpected results can influence the direction of the work.